

working towards that. However, this has to be looked through the prism of people's welfare along with economic development. I have been continuously emphasising that our Dravidian model of development should be steered by the inclusivity criterion, embracing everyone, every sector and every district. Mere economic development is not our goal. I would like to see holistic development in Tamil Nadu that spans the social, political, economic and cultural domains. All our policies are planned accordingly. Through the recently launched Naan Mudhalvan (I am the first) scheme, industry-relevant skills are being imparted to the youth. We intend to transform the youth force of Tamil Nadu into an intellectual force, with a focus on linking it to industrial development. We also want the employment scenario in the state to be inclusive and friendly to women, persons with disabilities and the marginalised sections. This is the unique character of the Dravidian model.

"WE INTEND TO TRANSFORM TAMIL NADU'S YOUTH FORCE INTO AN INTELLECTUAL FORCE, AND LINK IT WITH INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT"

Q. What is your view on Centre-state relations?

'Autonomy in state, federalism at the Centre' is the fundamental, time-tested principle of our movement since the times of Perarignar Anna and Muthamizharignar Kalaignar. The Constitution rightly defines India as a 'Union of States'. The Union government should respect state governments, lend an ear to our demands and fulfil them. Sadly, the present BJP government does not do any of the above. They bring in legislation binding on all states without consulting any of us. This must change.

Q. On a personal note, what do you do to relax?

As I carry two big responsibilities—of being Tamil Nadu's chief minister and president of the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam—on my shoulders, my usual relaxation is going for walks. In addition to that, I do yoga when I get time. I read new books presented to me by my party cadre and friends. I also take a brief look at social media platforms to understand the opinions of people on current affairs.

Q. What is the one thing that you learned from your father, the late M. Karunanidhi who was chief minister for nearly two decades?

He liked to work, work and work. It was he who taught me to work hard. I am determined about continuing to work as hard as he did. ■

150 G2B (government-to-business) online services spanning over 25 departments are already on the Tamil Nadu Single Window portal. Another 86 services will go live on it shortly. There is also an attempt to jettison archaic laws and processes to improve EODB and implement the 301 reform points under the Business Reforms Action Plan (BRAP) of the DPIIT (Department for the Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade). The efforts seem to have borne fruit, as Tamil Nadu has made a leap from the 14th position in EODB rankings in 2019 to No. 3 now. Another innovation has been the government's Biz Buddy portal, an online industrial helpdesk to redress the grievances of investors and industries in a transparent, time-bound and hassle-free manner. More than 20 departments and over 100 agencies manned by 150 officers on Biz Buddy ensure speedy resolution of industry-related grievances with an inbuilt escalation matrix right up to the chief minister's office.

TAMIL NADU IS IN TOP 5 IN 9 OUT OF 12 CATEGORIES: ECONOMY, HEALTH AND EDUCATION AMONG THEM

While pushing industry, Stalin has not forgotten agriculture. Tamil Nadu is among the few states to have a separate budget for agriculture. The state has provided free electricity to its farmers and taken up several projects to ensure the availability of water and reduce dependence on the monsoons. Under the new Kalaignarin All Village Integrated Agriculture Development Programme, coconut saplings, saplings for home farming, horticultural saplings, essential sprays, kits for vegetable gardens, etc. are distributed and a 100 per cent subsidy